Parashat Vayera — The Story in Plain Words

One hot afternoon, Abraham is sitting at the entrance of his tent when three strangers appear. He runs to welcome them, washes their feet, and serves them bread, curds, and a calf. They tell him that Sarah will have a son — and Sarah, listening inside the tent, laughs.

The visitors turn toward Sodom. God shares the plan to judge the city, and Abraham speaks up: would God destroy the righteous together with the wicked? He pleads, step by step, from fifty righteous people down to ten.

Two angels reach Sodom, where Lot welcomes them into his home. The city is destroyed; Lot escapes with his two daughters, but his wife looks back and becomes a pillar of salt.

Then the promises come true: Isaac is born to Sarah. Hagar and Ishmael are sent away, but God watches over them too. Abraham makes a covenant at Beersheba.

The portion ends on a mountain, with the hardest test of all: Abraham is asked to offer Isaac — and at the last moment, a ram is provided instead.